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What the AI Said

The real replies behind the slides, word for word.

From Jason Greer's session "Stop Starting Over." Free to use and share.

How these were made. Each prompt ran once, in a fresh Claude chat, in October 2026. The three plant prompts had the practice file production_runs.csv attached. The lines on the slides were lightly shortened from these replies. The only change here: one local file path was removed.

Your answers will differ. A different tool, different wording, or even running the same prompt twice will give you different words and sometimes different numbers. That's normal, and it's why you check.

WHAT'S INSIDE

1. The Room, on the practice plant
2. The 100 Tries, no data: the huddle (the full list of 100)
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5. What we found, and how we checked it

REPLY 1 OF 4

The Room, on the practice plant

WHAT I TYPED

Act as a panel of 4 people: a plant manager, a quality engineer, a second-shift press operator and a skeptic. Each one gives their view on this problem: scrap went up over the last 12 weeks at our plant and we need to know why. The production log is attached. Then let them respond to each other for 3 rounds. End with what they agree on and what they still disagree on.

Attached: production_runs.csv

I went through the whole log before writing this: 967 runs from April 6 to June 26, covering 4 presses, 4 parts, 7 operators and 2 material suppliers. Every number the panel quotes comes from your data. When a panelist goes past what the log shows, they say so.

OPENING VIEWS

Plant Manager Here's the top-level picture. Scrap was 2.1% in week 1 and 3.2% in week 12. Output stayed in the same range the whole time, roughly 42,000 to 58,000 parts a week, so volume doesn't explain it. When I sort the data the obvious way, four things jump out:

Cut	Worst	Everyone else
Press	Press 2: 3.3%	Presses 1, 3, 4: 2.1 to 2.5%
Material	Ridgeline: 2.7%	Cormont: 2.2%
Shift	2nd and 3rd: 2.8%	1st: 2.2%
Operator	Op 14: 3.0%, Op 22: 2.9%	Others: 2.1 to 2.4%

My gut says the problem is Ridgeline material plus second shift on Press 2. I need something I can act on this week, and I don't want to blame the wrong people or the wrong supplier.

Quality Engineer Those four rows are one problem showing up four ways. Take out one slice of the data, Press 2 runs that start after 2 pm (second and third shift), and the rest of the plant is flat: 2.27% in weeks 1 and 2, 2.20% in weeks 11 and 12. The whole increase lives in that one slice.

Inside that slice, scrap climbed steadily, from 1.7% in week 1 to 7.8% in weeks 11 and 12. It fell back to normal in only two weeks, week 3 (2.4%) and week 9 (2.1%). Those are the only two weeks Press 2 ran Cormont instead of Ridgeline.

But "bad Ridgeline material" doesn't hold up either. Press 2's day shift runs the same Ridgeline lots at about 2.1%. In week 12, lot Ridgeline 225 ran about 1.9% on day shift and 7.5 to 9.3% on nearly every second-shift run. Outside of Press 2's late shifts, Ridgeline and Cormont scrap at exactly the same rate, 2.23%. It isn't one part number either. All four parts are high on Press 2 after 2 pm.

One more thing worries me. All 30 of the Press 2 late-shift runs in weeks 10 to 12 passed first-piece inspection, and 28 of them still scrapped more than 5%. So the parts start out good and go bad during the run. The operator comments say the same thing. "Size creeping, dialed back" shows up 15 times in the log, and 11 of those are on Press 2.

Second-Shift Press Operator First, about Op 14 and Op 22 sitting at the top of that operator list: that's because we're the ones who run Press 2 at night. Put the three of us (Ops 14, 22 and 27) on Presses 1, 3 or 4 and we scrap 2.2 to 2.3%, same as day shift. Same people, same training, same material.

We've been writing it down since week 2: size creeps, we dial it back, we run slow to hold size, we hand-check every hour. Nobody followed up. When we got Cormont in week 9, the press behaved. The next week we were back on Ridgeline and it was worse than before.

I can't prove this from a spreadsheet, but my hunch is that it's about the state that press is in when we take it over at 2 pm, combined with that material. I'd want someone to look at what's different about Press 2 at 1:55 versus 2:05.

Skeptic Let me slow everyone down. Before I trust a story, I want to trust the log, and the log has problems.

- 168 of the 967 runs (17%) start before the previous run on the same press has ended. 132 of those start in the 2 pm hour, right at shift change, which is exactly where everyone wants to point. Either two jobs ran on one press at the same time, or the times around handover aren't reliable.
- The log says how many parts were scrapped but not why. There's no defect type, no die number, no press settings, and no record of which gauge or inspector made the call.
- Some key comparisons rest on very little data. Press 2's late shift only ran Cormont in two weeks, 21 runs in total.
- We have 12 weeks and nothing before April. Was 2.1% normal, or was it a good stretch?

I'm not saying anyone is wrong. I'm saying this log can tell us where to look, not what's broken.

ROUND 1

Plant Manager So it's not the supplier across the board, and it's not second shift across the board. That matters, because my first move would have been to call Ridgeline and have a talk with second shift, and both would have been aimed at the wrong target. Point taken on the operator list. How many parts are we actually losing here?

Quality Engineer If Press 2's late shift had run at the plant's normal 2.2%, we'd have scrapped about 1,700 fewer parts over these 12 weeks, about 470 of them in week 12 alone. That slice was 12% of plant scrap in weeks 1 and 2. By weeks 11 and 12 it was 34%.

To the Skeptic: fair point on the timestamps. But even if handover times are fuzzy and some scrap got booked to the wrong shift, Press 2's total scrap rate went from 1.8% in week 1 to 5.4% in week 12, and no other press moved. Sloppy bookkeeping can move scrap from one shift to another. It can't create scrap.

Second-Shift Operator And if you think our scrap is really day shift's scrap getting counted on our runs, then day shift on Press 2 would look too good. It doesn't. They're at 2.1%, the same as day shift on every other press.

Skeptic Fine. I'll accept that something real is happening on Press 2. But look at what the story needs: Press 2, and after 2 pm, and Ridgeline, all at once. When it takes three things lining up, there's often one hidden factor we can't see in the log, like a different die, a different gauge, or a different setup sheet on second shift. And here's the simplest question nobody has asked yet: has anyone measured the parts in the second-shift scrap bin on a gauge we trust? If those parts are actually good, we have a measuring problem, not a making problem.

ROUND 2

Plant Manager Here's what I want to do right now: put Press 2's second shift on Cormont until we figure this out. Week 9 says scrap drops right away. That stops the bleeding and buys time.

Skeptic It stops the bleeding and erases the evidence. Look at what happened after week 9. Press 2 went back to Ridgeline in week 10 and scrapped 6.5% on the late shift, higher than the 5.8% from the week before the switch. Whatever is wrong kept getting worse while Cormont was covering it up. Switch now and you'll feel better for a few weeks and learn nothing.

Quality Engineer I'm somewhere in between. The slow climb over 10 weeks looks like something wearing out or drifting: a die, a press component, a gauge, or the way people correct for size. The timing is sharp, too. Second-shift runs that start at 2 or 3 pm are already as bad as the ones that start later (4.8% vs 4.7%), and day-shift runs that carry past 2 pm are fine (2.1%). If this were the press heating up over the day, I'd expect a gradual slide, not a step right at shift change. So something changes at handover.

I also think Ridgeline is part of the cause, not just along for the ride. Both times Press 2's late shift ran Cormont, it was normal. My guess is that Ridgeline is less forgiving of whatever changes at handover, but that's a guess. Material certs from both suppliers would tell us.

What I'd do: 1. Compare Press 2 at the end of day shift and the start of second shift: settings, shims, feed, lube, die, and the gauge each shift uses. 2. Measure a sample of second-shift scrap on a trusted gauge and write down what's actually wrong with each part. 3. Run a planned test: same Ridgeline lot, same part, straight through the handover with no adjustments, checking size every 30 minutes.

Second-Shift Operator One more thing from the log, and I know the Skeptic won't like how small it is. A few times, day-shift operators covered an afternoon run on Press 2. In weeks 6, 10 and 12, when the problem was already showing, they scrapped 1.8 to 2.8%. Our crew on the same press in those same weeks was at 4.7 to 8.3%. So maybe it's not just the press. Maybe it's something we do when we take over, like how we dial it back when size creeps. If day shift does something different on that press in the afternoon, I want to know, because we'd copy it tomorrow.

ROUND 3

Skeptic That's only 6 runs in total, 4 of them in the weeks that matter. That's too few to clear or convict anyone. And at least one of them, Op 11's week 12 run that scrapped 1.8%, is logged as overlapping another operator's run on the same press. It's the same problem again: we're leaning on handover timestamps that don't add up.

Something else doesn't add up either. The comments say "ran slow to hold size," but those runs show about the same parts per hour as the other Press 2 late runs (166 vs 169). Either the slowdown is short or the log isn't capturing it.

I'm with the QE on running a real test. I'd change my mind quickly if scrap stays low through the handover with no adjustments, or if the parts in the scrap bin measure good.

Second-Shift Operator We slow down once it starts creeping, not for the whole run, so the totals would hide that. I'm fine with the test. I just want our crew running it, not being watched from the side. And I want the comments box to mean something. We were writing "size creeping" in week 2, when scrap was still under 2%.

Quality Engineer Agreed on all of that. Starting Monday, I'd also add defect type and die number to the run log, and fix how runs get logged at handover so they stop overlapping. Otherwise we'll be back here in three months with the same blind spot.

Plant Manager Okay, here's my compromise. Press 2's second shift runs Ridgeline only for the planned test runs and runs Cormont the rest of the time until the test is done. I'll ask both suppliers for certs, but I'm not filing a quality complaint against Ridgeline, because their material runs fine everywhere else. And nobody on second shift is getting written up over this. Their notes were the earliest warning we had.

WHAT THEY AGREE ON

1. **The increase is real and it's in one place.** It's Press 2 runs after 2 pm on Ridgeline material. The rest of the plant held steady at about 2.2% for all 12 weeks.
2. **It's not a plant-wide supplier problem.** Outside that one slice, Ridgeline and Cormont scrap at the same rate (2.23%).
3. **It's not a general second-shift skill problem.** The same three operators run normal scrap on Presses 1, 3 and 4. Ranking operators by scrap is misleading here.
4. **First-piece inspection isn't catching it.** Parts pass at startup and drift out during the run.
5. **The log shows where, not why.** The next step is on the floor: watch Press 2 at the 2 pm handover, measure the scrapped parts, compare day and night setups, and run a planned test.
6. **The log needs fixing.** Add defect type and die or tool ID, and clean up the overlapping run times at shift change.
7. **The operators flagged this early.** Their comments should have been followed up in week 2.

WHAT THEY STILL DISAGREE ON

1. **Containment.** The Plant Manager wants Cormont on Press 2's second shift now, because week 9 shows it works. The Skeptic thinks that hides a problem that keeps getting worse underneath, since scrap came back higher in week 10. The compromise (Cormont except during test runs) doesn't fully satisfy the Skeptic.

2. **Is Ridgeline a cause or just a trigger?** The QE thinks the material is part of the mechanism. The Operator thinks it's mainly the press. The Skeptic says it could be either, or a gauge.
3. **Is second-shift practice part of it?** The few day-shift runs on afternoon Press 2 hint that it might be. The Skeptic says 6 runs with shaky timestamps prove nothing. The Operator is open to it but still thinks the press's condition at handover matters more.
4. **Is all that scrap actually bad parts?** The Skeptic wants to rule out a gauge or counting problem before anyone touches the press. The QE thinks the "size creeping" comments and the steady climb make a real dimensional problem far more likely.

REPLY 2 OF 4

The 100 Tries, no data: the huddle

> **WHAT I TYPED**
> Imagine 100 different ways to solve this problem: our 10-minute start-of-shift huddle on the plant floor feels like a waste of time and people tune out. Sort them into best, average and worst. Then tell me what the best ones have in common and what the worst ones have in common.

Here are 100, sorted, one line each so you can scan them. The patterns are at the bottom.

BEST (30)

1. Ask the crew what feels useless about the huddle now, and redesign it with them.
2. Open with "What got in your way yesterday?" instead of the numbers.
3. Close the loop every day: "Yesterday you raised X. Here's what happened."
4. Keep a visible issues board with an owner and a due date on every item.
5. Send up what the supervisor can't fix, and bring the answer back next huddle (even if the answer is "no, and here's why").
6. Only share information that changes what someone does in the next 8 hours. Post the rest on a board.
7. Cover today's specific risks: changeovers, short staffing, material shortages, maintenance windows, new people on the line.
8. Make the safety part about today's work (a real near miss from this line), not a generic reminder.
9. Get 2 or 3 handoff items from the outgoing shift: what broke, what's running rough, what's waiting.
10. Hold it standing at the line or the board, where the work actually happens.
11. Use a fixed 3-part agenda (safety, yesterday, today) so people know what's coming.
12. Start on time, and end early when there's nothing left to say.
13. Show yesterday as hour-by-hour green and red against plan, and ask why the reds happened.
14. Have operators update the board themselves before the huddle starts.
15. Rotate who runs it among operators, not just the supervisor.
16. Ask one real question and wait through the silence for an answer.
17. Go around fast: each person names one thing they need or one risk they see (passing is fine).
18. Pick one small problem a day for the crew to fix, and let them fix it.
19. Give the crew authority over small fixes, like a standing yes for anything under a set dollar amount.
20. Hold up the actual bad part when you talk about a quality issue.
21. Bring in maintenance or quality for 2 minutes when they're the ones who can answer the question.
22. Give specific, earned recognition ("Maria caught the misfeed before it scrapped a pallet"), not general thanks.
23. Split a big crew into smaller huddles by area so the content fits the people in front of you.
24. Make sure everyone can hear and understand it: a quieter spot, translation, or a bilingual lead.
25. Drop any recurring topic that hasn't led to an action in two weeks.
26. Train supervisors and leads on how to run a huddle, and have someone watch and coach them.
27. Have plant leadership show up now and then to listen, not to talk.
28. Track "issues raised vs. issues fixed" and post the number where everyone can see it.
29. Run the new version as a 2-week experiment, then have the crew vote keep, change, or kill on each part.
30. Make the huddle where today's assignments and rotations get set, so it's the one place you get information you actually need.

AVERAGE (40)

31. Cut it from 10 minutes to 5 (helps, but doesn't fix boring content).
32. Use a timer so it never runs over.
33. Stand in a circle instead of rows.
34. Redesign the whiteboard so it looks cleaner.
35. Put up a TV dashboard with live numbers.
36. Do a 2-minute stretch or warm-up (good for bodies, neutral for attention).
37. Rotate a "safety moment" presenter.
38. Share a real customer story or complaint about your product.
39. Share company news and updates.
40. Celebrate birthdays and work anniversaries.
41. Put up a recognition board.
42. Add a quick safety trivia question.
43. Open with a fun fact or riddle.
44. Bring donuts or coffee on Fridays.
45. Play music to signal the start.
46. Only hold huddles on certain days of the week.
47. Move the huddle to a different time in the shift.
48. Rotate the location around the floor.
49. Use a microphone or PA system.
50. Hand out a printed one-page agenda.
51. Pick a weekly theme (ergonomics week, housekeeping week).
52. Teach a 2-minute lesson on problem solving or a lean tool.
53. Show short training videos.
54. Invite someone from another department now and then.
55. Have the plant manager attend once a week.
56. Run a quarterly survey about the huddles.
57. Add a QR code for anonymous issue reporting.
58. Use a suggestion box.
59. Start a shift-vs-shift production contest (can turn into shifts blaming each other).
60. Add points or a leaderboard for safety ideas.
61. Run the huddle from a tablet or app.
62. Post notes afterward for people who missed it.
63. Swap to a longer weekly meeting plus a very short daily check-in.
64. Cold call someone with a question to keep people alert (it does, and it also keeps them nervous).
65. End with the supervisor asking "Any questions?" (usually gets silence).
66. Copy the format from another plant that does it well (fine if you adapt it, bad if you don't).
67. Give small prizes for good ideas.
68. Show a monthly trend chart instead of daily numbers.
69. Add a "term of the day" for a skill or process.
70. Read one positive customer review.

WORST (30)

71. Make it longer so you can cover everything.

72. Lecture people about why the huddle matters.
73. Write people up for not paying attention.
74. Add a sign-in sheet to prove attendance.
75. Read the full KPI report out loud, line by line.
76. Read corporate emails and memos word for word.
77. Quiz people on huddle content, with consequences for wrong answers.
78. Scold the whole crew for one person's mistake.
79. Call out low performers by name in front of everyone.
80. Ask for input, write it down, and never act on it.
81. Turn it into a slideshow in the breakroom.
82. Move it to a conference room away from the floor.
83. Hold it before clock-in so it's unpaid time.
84. Move it to the end of the shift, when everyone wants to leave.
85. Have senior leaders give motivational speeches.
86. Put up motivational posters.
87. Throw a pizza party to fix morale.
88. Require everyone to share something positive.
89. Do icebreakers ("If you were a tool, what tool would you be?").
90. Recite the mission statement or company values every day.
91. Repeat the same generic safety slogan every day.
92. Use the huddle for the supervisor to vent.
93. Announce bad news (layoffs, cut hours) there, with no time for questions.
94. Add a second huddle mid-shift.
95. Cancel it and replace it with an email nobody on the floor reads.
96. Pay an outside facilitator to run your daily huddle.
97. Buy expensive huddle software before fixing the content.
98. Make a big show of banning phones without changing anything else.
99. Let every department head add their own 2-minute update.
00. Change the format every week so nobody knows what to expect.

WHAT THE BEST ONES HAVE IN COMMON

- **They make the huddle useful to the people standing in it.** Every item answers "What do I need to know or do in the next 8 hours?" If people could get it from a board or an email, it doesn't need airtime.
- **They close the loop.** This is the big one. People see the problems they raised get fixed, or at least get a straight answer. Once speaking up visibly works, people start paying attention because the huddle is where things get done.
- **They're two-way.** The crew talks at least as much as the supervisor, and what they say changes what happens.
- **They're specific.** This line, this shift, this part, this near miss. Nothing generic.
- **They're predictable and short.** Same time, same place, same structure, and done when it's done.
- **The crew owns part of it.** Running it, updating the board, picking problems to fix, voting on the format.

WHAT THE WORST ONES HAVE IN COMMON

- **They treat tuning out as a discipline problem when it's really a usefulness problem.** People usually tune out for a good reason: what they're hearing doesn't affect their shift, or nothing happens when they speak up.
- **They add control or volume instead of removing waste.** Sign-ins, write-ups, and quizzes add control. Longer meetings, more updates, and more speeches add volume. Neither makes the content more worth hearing.

- **They're one-way.** Reading, lecturing, announcing.
- **They're about the company, not about today's work.** Mission statements, memos, and slogans don't help anyone run their machine this morning.
- **They use gimmicks to cover weak content.** Pizza, posters, and icebreakers are a substitute for fixing the real issue.
- **Some of them embarrass or punish people,** which is the fastest way to guarantee silence.

The average ones mostly change the packaging: shorter, more fun, nicer screens, cleaner boards. They can help a little, but if the content still isn't useful, people will tune out of a shorter, prettier huddle too.

IF YOU ONLY TRY THREE THINGS

1. **Ask the crew** (#1): "What would make these 10 minutes worth your time?" You'll likely hear exactly what to cut.
2. **Use a tight structure**, something like: - Safety for today's work (1 min) - Yesterday: where we missed and why (2 min) - Today: risks, changeovers, assignments (2 min) - Open issues: owner and status (3 min) - "What do you need from me?" (2 min)
3. **Start every huddle by closing the loop** (#3) on something someone raised before.

A good test after a few weeks: when someone misses the huddle, do they ask a coworker what they missed? If yes, it's working.

If you share your crew size, what you cover today, and who runs it, I can help you draft a specific agenda and board layout.

REPLY 3 OF 4

The 100 Tries, with the plant data

> **WHAT I TYPED**
> Here is my data. It's 12 weeks of production runs from our plant, and scrap went up. Sort the runs from best to worst. What do the worst runs have in common? What do the best runs have in common?

Attached: production_runs.csv

Short answer: Almost all of your worst runs come from one combination: **Press 2, evening shift, running Ridgeline material.** Scrap from that combination has gone up almost every week, from about 2% to about 8%. The rest of the plant has held steady at about 2.2% for all 12 weeks. Your best runs don't share much at all. They are mostly ordinary runs that had a good day.

HOW I RANKED THEM

I ranked all 967 runs by scrap rate (units scrapped ÷ units produced), because run sizes vary from 380 to 900 parts. The plant overall scrapped 2.5%.

The full sorted list is saved here: production_runs_ranked.csv (not included here). Rank 1 is the best run.

Your file has no shift column, so I worked it out from start time. "Day" means the run started between 6am and 2pm, and "evening" means it started at 2pm or later. This lines up closely with your crews: Ops 11, 12, 13 and 15 almost always start runs in the morning, and Ops 14, 22 and 27 almost always start them in the afternoon or evening.

10 worst runs

Rank	Run	Start	Press	Part	Lot	Operator	Made	Scrapped	Scrap %
967	R-1826	Jun 16, 7:38pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 223	Op 22	855	86	10.1%
966	R-1957	Jun 26, 2:00pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 225	Op 14	616	57	9.3%
965	R-1843	Jun 17, 2:10pm	Press 2	Flange D	Ridgeline 223	Op 14	382	34	8.9%
964	R-1925	Jun 24, 2:00pm	Press 2	Flange D	Ridgeline 225	Op 22	793	69	8.7%
963	R-1926	Jun 24, 6:42pm	Press 2	Bracket B	Ridgeline 225	Op 22	592	51	8.6%
962	R-1942	Jun 25, 6:29pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 225	Op 14	883	76	8.6%
961	R-1941	Jun 25, 2:10pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 225	Op 14	567	48	8.5%
960	R-1959	Jun 26, 10:56pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 225	Op 14	391	33	8.4%
959	R-1891	Jun 22, 6:05pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 225	Op 27	536	45	8.4%
958	R-1740	Jun 9, 2:15pm	Press 2	Bracket A	Ridgeline 221	Op 14	704	59	8.4%

10 best runs

Rank	Run	Start	Press	Part	Lot	Operator	Made	Scrapped	Scrap %
1	R-1123	Apr 16, 6:05am	Press 3	Housing C	Cormont 114	Op 13	529	3	0.57%
2	R-1777	Jun 11, 10:03am	Press 3	Flange D	Cormont 128	Op 15	522	3	0.57%
3	R-1772	Jun 11, 6:10am	Press 2	Bracket B	Ridgeline 221	Op 15	659	4	0.61%
4	R-1552	May 25, 12:05pm	Press 1	Bracket B	Ridgeline 217	Op 15	475	3	0.63%
5	R-1821	Jun 16, 2:15pm	Press 1	Flange D	Ridgeline 222	Op 14	440	3	0.68%
6	R-1696	Jun 4, 2:15pm	Press 3	Bracket B	Cormont 126	Op 27	675	5	0.74%
7	R-1155	Apr 20, 2:10pm	Press 3	Bracket B	Cormont 116	Op 22	636	5	0.79%

Rank	Run	Start	Press	Part	Lot	Operator	Made	Scrapped	Scrap %
8	R-1045	Apr 9, 2:10pm	Press 2	Housing C	Ridgeline 201	Op 27	624	5	0.80%
9	R-1279	Apr 29, 2:05pm	Press 4	Flange D	Ridgeline 209	Op 22	546	5	0.92%
10	R-1280	Apr 29, 5:10pm	Press 4	Bracket A	Ridgeline 209	Op 22	435	4	0.92%

WHAT THE WORST RUNS HAVE IN COMMON

They are Press 2 + evening + Ridgeline. All 25 of the worst 25 runs fit that description, and so do 49 of the worst 50. Only 103 runs out of 967 (11%) fit it, but they produced 21% of all your scrap. In week 12 alone, they produced about 40% of the scrap.

It's this combination that drives the increase. Here is scrap % by week:

Week	Whole plant	Press 2, evening, Ridgeline	Everything else
1	2.1%	1.7%	2.2%
2	2.3%	1.9%	2.3%
3	2.1%	n/a (Press 2 ran Cormont)	2.1%
4	2.4%	3.0%	2.3%
5	2.4%	4.2%	2.2%
6	2.6%	4.4%	2.3%
7	2.6%	4.8%	2.3%
8	2.5%	5.8%	2.1%
9	2.4%	n/a (Press 2 ran Cormont)	2.4%
10	2.7%	6.5%	2.2%
11	2.6%	7.8%	2.1%
12	3.2%	7.8%	2.3%

"Everything else" stays flat. If those Press 2 evening runs had scrapped at the normal rate, week 12 would have come in around 2.3%, not 3.2%. Over the 12 weeks, that's roughly 1,700 extra scrapped parts.

All three conditions have to be present. Take away any one of them and scrap goes back to normal:

- Press 2, **day** shift, Ridgeline: 2.1%. In week 12, the **same lot** (Ridgeline 225) ran 1.9% on days and 7.8% on evenings, so it isn't simply a bad lot.
- Press 2, evening, **Cormont**: 2.3%. In weeks 3 and 9, when Press 2 ran Cormont, the evening problem disappeared. It came straight back once Ridgeline returned.
- **Other presses**, evening, Ridgeline: 2.3%. Ridgeline material isn't a problem on its own.

It doesn't come down to one or two people. Ops 14 and 22 have the highest overall scrap (3.0% and 2.9%). That's because they staff most Press 2 evening runs. Outside that combination they come in at 2.2% to 2.3%, the same as everyone else.

The problem shows up during the run, not at setup. 102 of the 103 problem runs passed their first-piece check. Most of the operator comments on these runs are about parts slowly going out of size: "size creeping, dialed back," "ran slow to hold size," "hand checking every hour." The evening crew can see the drift happening and is working around it.

A clue worth following up: six times, a day-shift operator ran Press 2 on Ridgeline in the afternoon, and all six came in between 1% and 3%. On June 24, for example, Op 11 ran 1.8% at 3:32pm, while the evening runs on either side of it ran 8.7% and 8.6% on the same press and lot. Six runs is a small sample, but it hints that the cause is how Press 2 is set up or run in the evening, not just the time of day.

WHAT THE BEST RUNS HAVE IN COMMON

Honestly, not much. The best 10% of runs (0.6% to 1.4% scrap) include every operator, every part, both materials in even numbers, both shifts in even numbers, and every week.

A lot of this is normal luck. A typical run of about 650 parts at 2.2% should scrap around 14 parts, and anywhere from about 7 to 22 is ordinary run-to-run variation. Your best run scrapped 3 parts. I don't see a recipe in the best runs that you could copy.

The one mild pattern is the press. **Press 3** shows up most among the best runs (39% of the top 10%, against 26% of all runs), followed by Press 1. **Press 4** shows up least. Leaving out the problem combination, Press 3 averages 2.1%, Presses 1 and 2 average 2.2%, and Press 4 averages 2.5%. Press 4's gap is small and hasn't grown, so it isn't behind the increase. It might still be worth a look later.

WHAT I'D CHECK NEXT

The data shows where and when the scrap happens, but not why. These are the things I'd look into:

1. **Compare day and evening setups on Press 2 for Ridgeline.** Look at offsets, speed, die settings, lubrication, and any adjustments the evening crew habitually makes. Talking with the evening operators is probably the fastest way to find out.
2. **Look for something on Press 2 that has been getting gradually worse since about week 4**, such as die or guide wear, or a setting that has been nudged a little further each week. Steady week-over-week growth points to something gradual, not a one-time event.
3. **Compare Ridgeline and Cormont specs and certs** (thickness, hardness, flatness). Ridgeline may sit closer to a limit that only matters when Press 2 is in its evening condition.
4. **Measure parts from the same lot on day and evening shifts**, and check how much the press heats up over the afternoon.
5. **Add in-process size checks on Press 2 evening runs for now.** First-piece inspection isn't catching this.

TWO NOTES ON THE DATA

- The comments column is blank for 84% of runs, so the comments are useful clues but don't tell the whole story.
- In 168 cases, a run starts before the previous run on the same press has ended. Either "machine" covers more than one station, or the start and end times are approximate. This doesn't affect the scrap ranking, but keep it in mind if you use the times for anything else.

If you'd like, I can drill into the Press 2 runs hour by hour or split them by part, or make charts of the weekly trend.

REPLY 4 OF 4

The Daily Loop, on the practice plant

WHAT I TYPED

Help me find out why scrap went up using Plan, Do, Check, Act. The production log for the last 12 weeks is attached.
Plan: What should I try?
Do: What exactly should I do today?
Check: How will I know if it worked?
Act: What should I change next time?
At the end, write me a better version of this prompt to use tomorrow.

Attached: production_runs.csv

I went through all 967 runs in the log. The short version: **the increase is not plant-wide. Almost all of it comes from one spot: Press 2, on the evening crew, running Ridgeline coil.** Everything else has held steady at about 2.2% for all 12 weeks.

WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Plant scrap went from about **2.2%** in the first three weeks to **2.8%** in the last three, and **3.2%** last week (about 1,070 scrapped parts a week up to about 1,470).

When I split it by press and shift, one line stands out:

Week of	Whole plant	Press 2, evening crew	Everything else
Apr 6	2.1%	1.7%	2.2%
Apr 13	2.3%	2.0%	2.3%
Apr 20	2.1%	2.4% (Cormont coil)	2.1%
Apr 27	2.4%	3.0%	2.3%
May 4	2.4%	4.2%	2.2%
May 11	2.6%	4.7%	2.3%
May 18	2.6%	4.8%	2.3%
May 25	2.5%	5.8%	2.1%
Jun 1	2.4%	2.1% (Cormont coil)	2.5%
Jun 8	2.7%	6.8%	2.2%
Jun 15	2.6%	7.8%	2.1%
Jun 22	3.2%	8.3%	2.3%

"Evening crew" here means Op 14, Op 22 and Op 27, who only work the 2 pm and later shifts.

It's not just the press, not just the coil, and not just the people. It's the combination:

Situation	Scrap rate
Press 2 + evening crew + Ridgeline coil	**4.9%** overall, **7.7%** in the last 3 weeks
Same press, same Ridgeline coil, day crew	2.1%
Same press, same evening crew, Cormont coil	2.3%
Same evening operators on Presses 1, 3 and 4	2.3%

Other things I noticed:

- **It's not one person.** All three evening operators run high on Press 2 with Ridgeline (4.0% to 5.3%) and normal everywhere else.
- **It's not one part.** All four parts run high in that slice.
- **The two "Cormont weeks" are a natural test.** In the weeks of Apr 20 and Jun 1, Press 2 ran Cormont coil and evening scrap dropped right back to normal. Then it jumped back up when Ridgeline returned.
- **The operators are already telling you what's happening.** In that slice, the comments "size creeping, dialed back" (10 of the 15 times it appears in the whole log) and "ran slow to hold size" (7 of 13) keep coming up.
- **The first-piece check isn't catching it.** 96 of the 97 problem runs passed first piece. Parts start out good and drift out of size during the run.
- **It crept up slowly.** There was no single bad day. That kind of slow climb usually comes from something wearing, drifting or warming up, or from a setting that gets nudged a little further each time. A single bad batch looks different.
- **Your last 3 weeks of this slice: 28 runs, every one between 5.5% and 10.1%.** For comparison, 95% of all other runs in the plant come in under 3.5%.

If Press 2's evening runs had been normal, last week's plant scrap would have been about **2.3% instead of 3.2%**, or roughly 470 fewer scrapped parts.

Two things to know about the data before you act on it: 1. The log covers **Apr 6 to Jun 26**. If you have runs since then, check that the pattern still holds. 2. **168 runs overlap in time with another run logged on the same press.** For example, on Jun 24 the log shows Op 22 running Press 2 from 2:00 to 6:23 pm and Op 11 running Press 2 from 3:32 to 7:49 pm. Both can't be true. The main pattern is strong enough that this doesn't change it, but some times or press numbers are getting entered wrong.

The log tells you **where** the problem is and **when** it started. It can't tell you **why**. That part you'll only find at the press.

PLAN: WHAT SHOULD I TRY?

Problem statement: Press 2 scrap on evening shifts with Ridgeline coil has climbed from about 2% in early April to about 8% in late June. The same press on days, and the same people on other presses, stay around 2.2%. Parts pass first piece, then drift out of size during the run.

Top suspects, most likely first:

1. **How Press 2 is set up or adjusted on evenings for Ridgeline coil.** Same press and coil are fine on days, and the same people are fine on other presses, so something about the evening setup on that press is different. That could be different settings, an old setup sheet, or the press getting "dialed back" a bit more each time size drifts until it's far from where it should be.
2. **Press 2 drifts as it warms up, and Ridgeline coil is less forgiving.** The climb runs from April into summer. Afternoons and evenings are the hottest part of the day, and the comments are all about size creeping over the run. (One clue against this: the handful of times the day crew ran Press 2 in the late afternoon, scrap stayed around 2%. But that's only 6 runs.)
3. **Size is measured differently on evenings.** A different or worn gauge would make good parts look bad, and could cause a slow, steady climb like this one.

What to try: For one evening run, **use the day crew's exact Press 2 settings for Ridgeline coil, and check size every 30 minutes.** Keep everything else the same: same operators, same coil, same parts.

Why this test first: it's cheap and safe, and it tells suspect 1 and suspect 2 apart in a single shift. If size holds and scrap drops, it's the setup or adjustments. If size still creeps on day settings, it's the press or the heat, and you move to suspect 2.

If you need scrap down right now while you figure it out: keep Ridgeline coil off Press 2 on evenings (Cormont on Press 2 evenings ran 2.3%, and Ridgeline on other presses ran 2.3%). That stops the bleeding, but it won't tell you the cause, so treat it as a bandage and not the fix.

DO: WHAT EXACTLY SHOULD I DO TODAY?

Before 2 pm 1. **Record the day crew's Press 2 settings** for Ridgeline coil: whatever your setup sheet covers (shut height, tonnage, feed, speed, lube, and so on). A photo of the control panel works. 2. **Check the evening gauge** against a known-good master part, or against the day crew's gauge. This takes 10 minutes and rules suspect 3 in or out. 3. **Put a simple sheet at Press 2** with these columns: time, size on 5 parts, any adjustment made (and what), press or room temperature if you can get it, scrap count since the last check.

At the 2 pm shift change

4. **Be there for the handoff.** Ask the evening operator, "What usually happens to size as the run goes, and what do you do about it?" Go in curious. The numbers show this isn't one person's fault, and their comments show they've been fighting it.
5. **Start the run on the day settings.** If parts drift out of spec, they should still adjust. Just ask them to write down every adjustment on the sheet.

During the run

6. **Measure 5 parts every 30 minutes** and fill in the sheet.
7. **Keep scrap in its own tote,** sorted by reason if you can (size, burr, other).

End of shift

8. Count good and scrapped parts and work out the scrap rate for the run.

CHECK: HOW WILL I KNOW IF IT WORKED?

Decide the target before you start: a Press 2 evening run on Ridgeline coil **under 3.5%**. That's the top of the normal range for every other press and shift.

- **Baseline to beat:** 7.7% over the last 3 weeks, and **none of the last 28 runs came in under 5.5%.** So even one run under 3.5% is a real signal, not luck. Still, confirm it with 3 to 5 more runs (about a week) before you call it fixed.
- **Read the size sheet, not just the scrap count:**
- Size stays flat: the settings or adjustments were the problem.
- Size creeps steadily from hour 1 to hour 4: it's heat or the press. Move to suspect 2.
- Size jumps right after adjustments: the adjusting itself is making scrap.
- **Watch weekly:** track two numbers, Press 2 evenings and everything else. If the fix holds, both should sit around 2.2% and the plant should drop back to about 2.2% to 2.3%.

ACT: WHAT SHOULD I CHANGE NEXT TIME?

If it worked - Write the settings on a Press 2 setup sheet for Ridgeline coil, post it at the press, and walk all three evening operators through it. - Add a **mid-run size check**. First piece alone is missing this problem. - Find out **why** evenings drifted from day settings in the first place: a missing handoff, an old setup sheet, a workaround someone was taught? Fix that, or it will creep back.

If it didn't work - Move to suspect 2. Have maintenance look at Press 2 in the late afternoon (oil temperature, lube, die temperature), and change one thing at a time. - Ask Ridgeline for the material certs on recent lots compared with the early ones (201, 203). Something may be close to the edge of spec in a way only Press 2 is sensitive to.

Either way, make the log work harder for you - **Add a scrap reason column** (size, burr, crack, and so on). Right now you can see how much scrap there is but not why. - **Fix the start and end times.** 168 runs overlap with another run on the same press. - **Add a "settings changed? yes/no" column.** - **Review scrap by press and shift every week, not just the plant total.** Press 2 evenings hit 3.0% in late April and 4.2% the week after, but the plant total only moved a few tenths of a point, so it stayed hidden for two months. A simple rule: flag any press and shift above 3.5% two weeks in a row.

A BETTER PROMPT FOR TOMORROW

Your prompt was a good start. The PDCA structure is right. What makes the next one better is giving more context, feeding back what happened today so the loop actually closes, and asking for one test with a success number set ahead of time. Fill in the brackets:

> I run a [stamping] plant with 4 presses making [parts / what they're for]. "Scrap" means [what counts as scrap for us]. Normal scrap for us is about 2.2%.
>
> Attached is our production log, one row per run, from [start date] to [end date]. Columns: run_id, start/end time, machine, part, material_lot (supplier + lot number), operator, units_produced, units_scrapped, first_piece_result, downtime_min, comment. Shifts start at [6 am, 2 pm and 10 pm]. Op 14, 22 and 27 work evenings; Op 11, 12, 13 and 15 work days.
>
> What we already know: Plant scrap rose from about 2.2% to 3.2% over 12 weeks. Nearly all of the increase is Press 2, evening crew, Ridgeline coil (about 8% last week). The same press on days, and the same operators on other presses, stay around 2.2%. Parts pass first piece and then drift out of size during the run.
>
> What I tested yesterday: [the change, e.g. "ran Press 2 evenings on day-shift settings"].
> Results: [units produced and scrapped per run, size readings every 30 minutes, adjustments made, gauge check result, anything operators said].
>
> Constraints: [e.g. can't stop production, no new equipment this month, maintenance available Tuesday].
>
> Please run the next PDCA loop:
> 1. Check: Did yesterday's test work, compared with the 7.7% baseline? How confident should I be given how many runs I have?
> 2. Plan: What are the top 3 likely causes now, ranked, with the evidence for and against each? What can't the data tell us?
> 3. Do: Pick ONE change to test next. Give me step-by-step instructions for one shift, including what to measure and how often.
> 4. Check: Set a success number before I start, and tell me how many runs I need before I trust the result.
> 5. Act: What should I make standard if it works, and what should I try next if it doesn't?
>
> Use plain language and show the key numbers in a small table. If anything in the data looks wrong or missing, tell me before you analyze it.

If you paste in tonight's size sheet and run totals tomorrow with this prompt, you'll get a much sharper next step than starting from scratch.

SPOILER: TRY THE PROMPTS FIRST

What we found, and how we checked it

Don't take the AI's word for a number. Don't take ours either. Every number below can be checked in a spreadsheet in about ten minutes.

HOW TO CHECK

1. Open production_runs.csv in Excel or Google Sheets.
2. Add a column for scrap rate: units_scrapped ÷ units_produced.
3. Add a column for shift: a run that starts at 2 pm or later is second shift.
4. Sort and filter. For a group of runs, scrap rate = total scrapped ÷ total produced.

WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Check	Result
The 25 worst runs by scrap rate	**All 25** are Press 2, second shift, Ridgeline steel
How common that spot is	102 of 967 runs, about 1 in 10 (103 if you count one second-shift run that started at 12:34 am)
Take away the shift: Press 2, day crew	2.1% (115 runs)
Take away the steel: Press 2, evening crew, Cormont steel	2.3% (21 runs)
Take away the press: Ridgeline on Presses 1, 3 and 4	2.3% (347 runs)
The rest of the plant	2.2%, steady for all 12 weeks
Operator 14, overall	3.0%, the highest of the seven operators
Operator 14 on Press 2 vs. the other presses	**4.8% vs. 2.3%.** Operator 22: 4.3% vs. 2.2%. Operator 27: 3.5% vs. 2.2%.
Why Operator 14 tops the list	He works 54 of Press 2's 122 runs that start at 2 pm or later. He's just there the most.
The spot, last 3 weeks	7.7% across 28 runs. The lowest single run was 5.5%.
Everything else	About 95% of all other runs come in under 3.5%
What it cost	About 1,700 extra scrapped parts in 12 weeks, compared with the rest of the plant's 2.2%
The first warning	Week 2, a Press 2 run at 2:00 pm, comment: "size creeping, dialed back"

SAME RUNS, THREE COUNTS

The file has no shift column, so each count depends on how you define second shift. The Daily Loop chat counted the problem runs by crew (Operators 14, 22 and 27) and got 97. The 100 Tries chat counted any run that didn't start between 6 am and 2 pm as evening, which picked up one run that started at 12:34 am, and

got 103. The spreadsheet, counting runs that start between 2 pm and midnight, says 102. None of them is wrong. They just counted differently. Tell the AI how you count before it counts.

WHAT THE DATA CAN'T TELL YOU

Why. The parts pass first piece and then drift out of size during the run, and the operators have been writing it down since week 2. The next step isn't another prompt. It's a conversation at Press 2 with the second-shift crew.

AI finds where. You still find why.

Questions later? Jason Greer · Jason@peelbusinessdesign.com